

Magnifying Transmitter

Electrical engineering pioneer Nikola Tesla (see p.155) was a visionary and a practical inventor. He believed it was possible to distribute electrical power wirelessly around the world by the transmission of high-voltage, high-frequency alternating currents. In 1899, he moved to Colorado Springs, CO, where he built the Magnifying Transmitter, which was capable of generating millions of volts and discharging sparks several yards long. Tesla spent nine months there, keeping a diary of his experiments. He returned to New York to continue his work into wireless transmission, before running out of financial backers. Tesla's dream of transmitting electric current wirelessly around the world is yet to be realized.

“... I feel certain that of all my inventions, the Magnifying Transmitter will prove most important and valuable to future generations.”

Nikola Tesla, *My Inventions*, 1919